Yağmur Kiper

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she/her/hers
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Research Interests

Primary	theoretical syntax; C/case, ellipsis, copular clauses, nominalizations, relative clauses
Secondary	theoretical semantics; evidentiality, modality, aspect, attitude reports

Education

2022–2027 **Ph.D. in Linguistics**
University of California, Santa Cruz
Committee: Mia Gong & Maziar Toosarvandani (co-chairs), Ivy Sichel
Dissertation: The illusion of case (*tentative*)

2020–2022 **Ph.D. Studies in Language Studies**
Middle East Technical University, Ankara

2017–2020 **M.A. in English Language Teaching, Language Studies**
Middle East Technical University, Ankara
Thesis: *In the case of sluicing* (*awarded best thesis '21*)
Committee: Martina Gračanin-Yüksek (chair), Bilal Kırkıcı, İsa Kerem Bayırlı

2013–2017 **B.A. in Foreign Language Education**
Middle East Technical University, Ankara

Appointments

2017–2019 **Lecturer, Department of Foreign Languages**
TOBB University of Economics and Technology

Papers

Articles Peer-reviewed by Abstract

in prep Two distinct mechanisms for genitive across nominalizations in Turkish. *Proceedings of the Fifty-Seventh Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society:* GLSA.

2026 Ellipsis as leverage for dependent case theory. In Gabriel Correa & Kevin Morand (eds.), *Proceedings of the Fifty-Sixth Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society:* GLSA.

2022 The position of the Q-like particle *ki* in Turkish and consequences for sluicing. In Marianne Huijsmans & Sander Nederveen (eds.), *Proceedings of the Northwest Linguistics Conference 37*. Vancouver, BC: UBCWPL.

Manuscripts

in prep — Sluicing as a lens on case.

2020 — *In the case of sluicing* [Master of Arts Thesis]. Middle East Technical University. OpenMETU.

Edited Volumes

2025 — *With Nikolas Webster, Richard Wang, & Sichen Larry Lyu*
Proceedings of the 41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (*WCCFL41*). Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press.

Presentations

Talks Peer-reviewed by Abstract

2026 — Distinct mechanisms for genitive case across nominalizations. *19th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics* (*WAFL 19*). The Leibniz-Centre General Linguistics; Berlin, Germany.

2025 — Ellipsis as leverage for dependent case. *56th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society* (*NELS 56*). NYU; New York.

2025 — Low sluicing is VPE. *Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America* (*LSA*). Philadelphia.

2021 — (Mis)matches in Turkish sluicing constructions. *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing* (*AMLaP*). Université de Paris; online.

2021 — Connectivity in Turkish sluicing. *23rd Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar* (*SICOGG 23*). Sogang University; online.

2021 — The position of the Q-like particle ki in Turkish and consequences for sluicing. *37th Annual Northwest Linguistics Conference* (*NWLC 37*). University of British Columbia; online.

2017 — L1 Turkish transfer in the acquisition of L2 English definite article. *11th Student Conference on Linguistics* (*DÖK 11*). Mersin University; Mersin, Türkiye.

2016 — L1 Turkish transfer in the acquisition of L2 English definite article. *T.W.I.S.T. Conference in Linguistics* (*TWISTx10*). Leiden University; Leiden, Netherlands.

Posters Peer-reviewed by Abstract

2026 — Two distinct mechanisms for genitive across nominalizations in Turkish. *57th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society* (*NELS 57*). CUNY; New York.

2026 — *with Emily Knick**
Perfect-like meanings in Turkish via temporal adverbials. *11th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic* (*Tu+11*). MIT; Boston, MA.

Invited Talks

2026 — Two distinct mechanisms for genitive case assignment across nominalizations. *Syntax & Semantics Circle* (*SSCircle*), University of California Berkeley.

2025 — The interaction between low sluicing and case licensing. *Syntax and Morphology Circle* (*SMircle*), Stanford University.

* = co-first author

Experience

Teaching

at University of California Santa Cruz

2026– **Instructor of Record**

LING 240: Teaching Assistant Training for Linguistics and Philosophy		Fall 2026

2023–present **Teaching Assistant**

LING 53: Semantics I	Roumyana Pancheva	Spring 2027
LING 53: Syntax I	Roumyana Pancheva	Winter 2027
LING 80K: Invented Languages	Andrew Angeles	Spring 2026
LING 116: Semantics II	Adrian Brasoveanu	Winter 2026
LING 53: Syntax I	Roumyana Pancheva	Fall 2025
LING 113: Syntax II	Ivy Sichel	Spring 2025
LING 116: Semantics II	Jess Law	Winter 2025
LING 53: Semantics I	Pranav Anand	Fall 2024
LING 53: Semantics I	Yaqing Cao	Summer 2024
LING 50: Introduction to Linguistics	Andrew Angeles	Spring 2024
LING 80D: Language and Mind	Rachel Walker	Winter 2024
LING 112: Syntax I	Ivy Sichel	Fall 2023

at Middle East Technical University

2019–2022 **Teaching Assistant**

FLE 433: Advanced Syntax	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Spring 2022
FLE 337: Aspects of Bi-/Multi-lingualism	Hale Işık Güler	Spring 2022
FLE 134: Contextual Grammar II	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Fall 2021
FLE 307: Language Acquisition	Çiğdem Sağın Şimşek	Fall 2021
FLE 333: Introduction to Syntax	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Fall 2021
FLE 337: Aspects of Bi-/Multi-lingualism	Bilal Kırkıcı	Spring 2021
FLE 261: Linguistics II	Martina Gračanin Yüksek	Spring 2021
FLE 146: Linguistics I	Hale Işık Güler	Fall 2020
FLE 425: School Experience	Işıl Günseli Kaçar	Fall 2020
FLE 420: Practice Teaching	Çiler Hatipoğlu	Spring 2020
FLE 426: The English Lexicon	Duygu Özge	Spring 2020
FLE 251: Critical Reading & Writing	Işıl Günseli Kaçar	Fall 2019

at TOBB University of Economics and Technology

2017-2019 **Instructor of Record**

ING 003: Professional Writing Skills
ING 002: Academic English II

ING 001: Academic English I

Integrated Language Skills

English Grammar

Mentoring

2026 *Copular Clauses and Case in "Altaic"* funded by Science Internship Program
Mentee(s): Allegra OGrady, Neo Zhang

2025 *Ellipsis Investigations in "Altaic"* funded by Science Internship Program
Mentee(s): Tanay Agrawal, Jonathan Ding, Adithya Gnanasundar, Dani Mattson

2024–2025 SLUG Career Mentorship Program, Department of Linguistics at UC Santa Cruz
Mentee(s): Ella Kohls

2024 *Applying to Grad School Workshop*, Department of Linguistics at UC Santa Cruz
with Ian Carpick & Richard Wang

Non-degree Training

2026 Equitable Course Design for GSIs
Teaching and Learning Center, UC Santa Cruz

2026 Graduate Pedagogy Fellowship Program
Teaching and Learning Center, UC Santa Cruz

2024 Preparing for Inclusive Teaching
Teaching and Learning Center, UC Santa Cruz

2023 The 5th Crete Summer School of Linguistics (CreteLing)
University of Crete, Greece

2023 Teaching as an Ethical Practice: A Guide for Teaching Assistants (online)
Teaching and Learning Center, UC Santa Cruz

2021 The NY-St. Petersburg Institute of Linguistics, Cognition and Culture (NYI)
Virtual

2019 DGfS xPrag Summer School
Leibniz-Centre General Linguistics (ZAS), Germany

2016 Erasmus Exchange in British and American Studies
University of Konstanz, Germany

Awards, Grants & Fellowships

Awards

2026 *First Generation Graduate Group Research and Travel Awards*, UC Santa Cruz ($500)

2021 *Best Graduate Thesis Award*, Middle East Technical University

Grants

2026 *Graduate Dean's Research Travel Grant*, UC Santa Cruz ($150)

2016 *Erasmus+ Grant for the Student Exchange Program*, Turkish National Agency and European Union (€2000)

Fellowships

2026 *Graduate Pedagogy Fellow*, UC Santa Cruz Teaching & Learning Center ($2000)

2025 *Humanities Summer Research Fellowship*, UC Santa Cruz Humanities Institute ($2500)

2022–2023 *Regents Fellowship*, UC Santa Cruz Department of Linguistics ($24,000)

2022 *Graduate Student Success Fellowship*, UC Santa Cruz Humanities Institute ($1500)

2017–2019 *National Scholarship Program for MA Students*, The Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey (TÜBİTAK) ($9000)

Service

Reviewing

Proceedings 11th Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (TU+11)

Department Service

2025–2026 Graduate Student Representative at Department of Linguistics, UC Santa Cruz

2023–2024 Coordinator, Syntax & Semantics Circle (S-Circle) at Department of Linguistics, UC Santa Cruz

2021–2022 Coordinator, Technical and Technological Support Group at Department of Foreign Languages, Middle East Technical University

2021–2022 Co-organizer, Formal Linguistics Meetings at Department of Foreign Languages, Middle East Technical University

2016–2017 Co-organizer, Colloquium Talk Series in Linguistics & Literature at Department of Foreign Languages, Middle East Technical University

2016 Co-founder, Language Studies Society

Conference Organizing

2023 Organizing Committee Member, 41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL 41), Department of Linguistics at UC Santa Cruz

2020–2021 Co-organizer, 34th National Conference on Turkish Linguistics (UDK 34), Department of Foreign Languages at Middle East Technical University

Others

2024, 2026 Member, Equity in Linguistics (EquiL) at UC Santa Cruz

2022–2024 Member, Linguistics Events Committee at UC Santa Cruz

Skills

Languages	Turkish (native), English (fluent), German (intermediate), Korean (research), Khalkha Mongolian (ex-situ fieldwork)
Programming	Python, R
Software	LaTeX, IBM SPSS, OpenSesame, Praat